

Dougal MacDonald: The Holodomor and Free Speech

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Dougal MacDonald, Education, here offers a public statement in regard to the controversy over remarks he made about the Holodomor in a post on Facebook.

The central issue here is freedom of speech. It is both a human right and a *Charter* right. I have investigated a historical issue for a number of years and I have presented my position on it. As even Wiki says, there is an ongoing debate on the issue. A few quotes from Wiki: “The causes, nature, and extent of the Holodomor remain topics of controversy and active scholarship.” And, “The reasons for the famine are a subject of scholarly and political debate.” Another quotation: “Scholars continue to debate whether the Holodomor was (on one extreme) man-made, intentional, and genocidal and (on the other) nature-made, unintentional, and ethnicity-blind. Whether the Holodomor is a genocide is a significant issue in modern politics.”

So, my post is simply my contribution to the debate on the issue. Yes, it may be a minority position and others may disagree with it but it is my right to present it and it is a credible position. Others who have espoused it include George Bernard Shaw and H. G. Wells, two pretty smart guys who visited the area, as well as the Prime Minister of France Edouard Herriot, who visited the area, the British House of Lords after an onsite investigation by expert John Maynard, English economists Herbert and Beatrice Webb, Pulitzer prize-winning U.S. journalist Walter Duranty, and U.S. journalist Louis Fischer. And so on. All of them were actually around at that time, unlike today, which is 85 years later.

Further research support for my position is the comprehensive 1987 book by Douglas Tottle titled “Fraud, Famine and Fascism”. Also, West Virginia University professor Mark Tauger has published along the same lines, stating, for example, that the causes of any food shortages were natural conditions. Grover Furr, professor of Medieval English literature at Montclair State University, has long researched the issue and has long questioned the “official version”. And so on.

As I mentioned, others may disagree with me and with those whom I refer to here but that is their right. However, what they are now doing is not their right, i.e., to name call, hurl insults, and threaten to get me fired from my job, which, by the way, has absolutely nothing to do with this topic. That is their pathetic attempt to shut down the debate on the issue, not to further the search for historical truth. So why are they doing this and what are they afraid of? That others may take up that search? Finally, may I point out that free and public debate on issues, especially controversial issues, is a healthy aspect of our society and is, in fact, necessary, if we are to make any progress toward building a better future.